Without a word, he picked up his telephone and dialed Max Arnow, a casting director for Warner Brothers.

“Max,” he said, “I have another Robert Taylor sitting in my office.”

“God made only one Robert Taylor,” Arnow said of Hollywood’s reigning male star, loud enough for me to hear his friendly burst of sarcasm.

Nevertheless, Arnow agreed to take a look at me.

My subsequent interview with Arnow was brief and left me with the impression of being appraised like a slab of beef.

I’ve often wondered what would have happened to me if Max Arnow hadn’t liked my voice.

He and Meiklejohn circled me like a pair of hummingbirds, talking about my face, my shoulders, and my height as if I wasn’t even in the room.

For some reason, Arnow said he was impressed by my voice. He said it reminded him of the voice of a young stock player Warners had put under contract but, for reasons I can’t remember, was giving the studio some kind of difficulty. I guess maybe Arnow thought of me as a kind of replacement for the guy with the voice like mine.

Meiklejohn was apparently a good salesman because he persuaded Arnow to give me a screen test. Arnow handed me a few pages from the script of a Broadway play, *The Philadelphia Story*, told me to memorize them, and return in several days.

At the end of the day, when I finally arrived on Catalina, Cubs Manager Charley Grimm chewed me out for being absent without leave.

I couldn’t bring myself to tell him that my mind was somewhere else; it was exploding with visions of a future of which he wouldn’t be a part.

I returned to Los Angeles by boat for the screen test and it lasted only a few minutes, just a Warners starlet and me exchanging a few lines from *The Philadelphia Story*.